

Hey Rohan, good speaking with you today. You asked exactly the right questions -- especially the one about Andrew Ng -- and you deserved sharper answers than you got, so here is my honest attempt at that.

Your questions answered

1 What is actually different from Andrew Ng / Coursera?

Andrew Ng is genuinely good -- no argument there. The real gap is not content, it is **execution infrastructure around the content**. Scaler gives you live classes 3x a week with industry instructors, 1:1 mentorship with people currently working in product companies, and 50+ hands-on projects -- none of which Coursera provides. More practically: you have 4 years of TCS on your resume and you are trying to cross into a product company. That crossing requires interview reps, a portfolio of real projects, and someone who can tell you 'your system design answer would not pass at Flipkart -- here is why.' A Coursera certificate does not give you that feedback loop. The Rs. 3.5L is not for the videos; it is for the structured path from where you are now to a product-company offer.

2 RAG, agents, evals -- is this program actually on that, or mostly theory?

You said you want to build real LLM applications, and this is one area where I can be specific. The curriculum explicitly includes **Prompt Engineering, RAG, and Multi-agent orchestration**, plus an Agentic AI elective -- these are listed as core, not optional add-ons. The program also covers end-to-end deployment (Backend Architecture, Full Stack), so you are not just learning to call an API; you are building systems that ship. Curriculum updates are included at no extra cost, which matters because the LLM tooling landscape changes every few months. For the exact depth of evals coverage and what shipped in the current cohort, admissions can walk you through that precisely on your next call -- I would rather you hear that from them than get a vague answer from me again.

3 Realistically, what salary jump does someone like you get?

You were direct about this -- 14 LPA to 16 LPA at another service company does not justify Rs. 3.5L, and you are right. I will not quote you a personal number because your outcome depends on your effort, the roles you target, and the market at the time you graduate. What I can tell you is that Scaler's published median salary hike for the DS/ML track is **~110%** -- that is a data point from their website, not a guarantee for your profile. The more relevant question is whether you land a product-company role versus another service role, and that is where the 900+ hiring partners and 100,000+ alumni network matter most -- it is a different funnel than applying cold. For benchmarks specific to a 4 YoE TCS-to-product-company switch in AI engineering, I would push admissions hard on that in your next call; they should have alumni data points that match your profile.

4 On the 'am I too late to AI' anxiety -- you are not, but the window is real

You said you keep seeing AI engineering roles and wondering if you are already too late. You are not late -- but the gap between 'I know ML theory' and 'I can build and deploy an agent pipeline' is where product companies are currently filtering. Your AWS cert and 4 years of backend work at HDFC and Citi projects is a stronger foundation than most people starting this transition. The entrance test is the first concrete step -- it is not a high-stakes exam, it is what gets you into the second conversation where you can pressure-test all of this with specifics.

TODAY Your current compensation depends on role and city. Happy to personalize on your next call.	TARGET PATH Stronger product and tech-facing roles depend on effort and market. We share realistic bands with admissions, not guesses.
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NOW Skills audit & entrance clarity	0-4 MO Core foundations & habits	4-8 MO Depth projects & design	8-12 MO Interview readiness
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Take the entrance test this week -- it is the one thing that unlocks the next conversation where you can get the exact numbers and cohort details your questions deserve.